JUST CHOCOLATE, ALLEGEDLY.

A four-part series for HOBA

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First draft
4 episodes · approx. 60 seconds each
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TONE
Witty, sensual, deadpan, mysterious.

VISUAL STYLE
Wes Anderson colour palettes, symmetry, inserts, pop zooms and bold design on title cards.

EPISODE 1

"Cost of Doing Business"

INT. BACKSTREET CORNER — DAY

A warm-toned alley, or a grotesque window frame. Everything in the frame looks still. Stylised.

THE SEEKER walks slowly into frame, eyes scanning. He spots THE GATEKEEPER, calm, reading a book.

THE SEEKER
(soft, deliberate)
Someone said… you have HOBA.

THE GATEKEEPER doesn't look up.

THE GATEKEEPER
Never heard of it.

THE SEEKER pulls out crisp naira bills. Offers it.

THE GATEKEEPER looks up. Takes the bills, slides them into his pocket and looks back down.

THE GATEKEEPER
Who sent you?

THE SEEKER
(almost in a whisper)
Mide.

THE GATEKEEPER
I might have heard of it.

THE SEEKER pulls out another couple of notes. Offers it.

THE GATEKEEPER closes his book. Looks up slowly. Takes the bills, slides them into his pocket.

THE GATEKEEPER
Ask for Sukina. Down by the —
Tell her curiosity sent you.

THE SEEKER nods, walks away. The camera pans slowly with him.

MUSIC CUE: Jazzy Yoruba groove kicks in.

TITLE CARD: HOBA. Some pleasures don't advertise.

EPISODE 2

"Supply and Demand, My Friend"

INT. APOTHECARY SHOP – EVENING

Wooden cabinets. Tiny glass jars. SUKINA sits behind a table, mixing herbs. She doesn't look up.

The Seeker enters. Hands on the counter. No words. Sukina glances at him, then back down at her work.

SUKINA
Who sent you?

THE SEEKER
(softly)
Curiosity.

Pause. Sukina nods subtly. Reaches under the table. Places a single HOBA bar in front of him.

SUKINA
Don't abuse it.

THE SEEKER
(excitedly)
Can I get another?

He pulls out some crisp naira bills, counts out a couple from the bundle. Offers it.

Sukina reaches for his hand, takes the bills he's counted out, takes a couple more from the bundle, pauses and just takes the entire bundle. She slides it under the table.

SUKINA
No. That's the last of my stash.

She returns to her work.

The Seeker attempts to complain or interject, he pauses, looks around, nods, takes the bar, exits.

CUT TO:

Slow-motion shot of the HOBA bar in his hand, glinting in the light.

TITLE CARD: HOBA. Chocolate. But… elevated.

EPISODE 3
"Plead the Fifth"

INT. THE SEEKER'S ROOM – NIGHT

Dim. Still. Retro furnishings. A single lamp lights the room.

The Seeker bites into the HOBA bar. Soft crunch. He closes his eyes, munches and exhales.

VOICEOVER (THE SEEKER)
"It hits just like an ancient prayer.
Slowly fulfilling."

He opens his phone.

Split screen: ZARA's name appears. He dials.

ZARA (on video call), silk robe, glass of wine in hand.

ZARA
(playful smirk)
Mmm. Look who's calling. Getting ready for our rematch, I see. Am I getting more than 2 minutes this time?

THE SEEKER
(laughing, cocky)
That was just nerves, Zara. Seeing you does something to a man. But tonight… I'm ready.

ZARA
(narrowing her eyes)
Ah! Don't tell me you took something, oh..

THE SEEKER
(grinning)
Just chocolate.

They lock eyes. She smirks.

He ends the call laughing.

TITLE CARD: HOBA. Preparation meets pleasure.

EPISODE 4
"Dispose the Evidence"

INT. THE SEEKER'S APARTMENT – NIGHT

Door opens. ZARA enters.

No talking. Just urgent energy. She grabs him.

Kiss. Spin. Clothes hit the floor.

FAST CUTS: Door slams. Clothes trailing like a map. Jazz playing. Bed creaks. The camera pans across the HOBA bar wrapper… forgotten.

MORNING LIGHT: ZARA walks around in his shirt. Picks up something.

ZARA
(mock gasp)
So this is your secret weapon? HOBA? You bad, bad boy.

THE SEEKER
(laughing from bed)
I never said I was unarmed.

ZARA
Oh. That's why you were Mr Olympics last night. Just chocolate, abi?

THE SEEKER
(grinning)
Allegedly. And how do you know about it? You bar-munching ho.

They laugh. She throws the wrapper at him. He catches it.

THE SEEKER
(running after her)
Come here.

VOICEOVER (THE SEEKER)
Some bars you eat. Others… you remember.

FINAL PRODUCT SHOT: HOBA bar in golden light on the nightstand. Elegant. Premium.

TITLE CARD: HOBA. Just Chocolate. Allegedly.